The Sea Is Closer Than You Think

Day 1 · Reading (1 of 2)

What to do: Read it aloud, one paragraph each. Stop at every blue word: can anybody explain it?

Vocabulary topic: The ocean, beaches and islands
20 new words (in blue) · EEW 1, Unit 9 · read about the ocean and islands and talk about nature and our habits



easy parts harder parts (most new words are here)

Close your eyes and think about a **beach**. What do you hear? Waves, birds, children. What do you smell? Salt and sun cream. The **ocean** covers more than seventy percent of our planet, and most of it is **still** unexplored. We know the surface of the Moon better than the bottom of the sea.

Every year the ocean teaches us something new. In 1977, scientists **discovered** strange animals near hot water at the bottom of the sea: they lived without any sunlight! Before that, nobody could **identify** such a place as a home for life. Today we know thousands of new animals, and every year we find more. The deep sea is a big mystery, and **perhaps** the next great discovery is waiting there.

Waves are made by wind. A strong wind far out at sea makes big waves, and after some days they arrive at the beach as slow, quiet waves. Some waves travel thousands of kilometers before they touch the sand.

Islands are special. Each **island** has its own plants and animals, and many of them live nowhere else. But islands are also fragile. When a big **wave** from a storm hits a small island, the **damage** can be huge. Many island communities now try to **prevent** the damage: they plant trees on the beach and build walls of **rock**. It is not easy to fight **against** the sea, but every **step** helps.

A walk on the beach is a great way to relax. The sand is warm, the water is cold and the air has a salty smell. Try this: put one finger in the sea water and **taste** it. It is very salty! Do not drink it: it is not good for you.

The Sea Is Closer Than You Think

Day 1 · Reading (2 of 2)

What to do: After reading: which paragraphs were easy, which were hard? Which blue words did you know already?

The ocean also has a big problem: plastic. Every year millions of tons of plastic go into the sea. Animals eat it, and sometimes people **throw** a bottle into the water without thinking. A small bottle looks harmless, but it needs hundreds of years to disappear. Scientists try to **fix** the problem with new machines, but the best solution is simple: do not throw it. We can **save** the sea, one beach at a time.

Here are some fun facts. The Pacific Ocean is bigger than all the land of the world together. An octopus has three hearts. In the Dead Sea you can float without moving, because the water is so salty. And sea water is salty because rivers carry a little salt from the rocks into the sea.

In your book, Unit 9, a girl on a beach throws starfish back into the water, one by one. A man says: “You cannot save all of them!” She answers: “No, but I can save this one.” It is a story about **emotion**: she is sad, and then she acts. Read it and tell your partner: do you think she is right?

Do you collect shells? Many people do. A shell is the house of a small animal, and when the animal dies, the empty shell stays on the beach. If you put a shell near your ear, you do not hear the ocean: you hear the noise of the air around you, made louder by the shape of the shell.

Tides are another wonder. Twice a day the sea comes up the beach, and twice a day it goes down. The Moon pulls the water, and the Sun helps a little. On an island with a big tide, people look at a special table before they go fishing: the table tells them the time of the water.

A **pleasant** day at the sea is good for everybody. But to be **frank**, many beaches today are not clean, and it is time to look at them with honest eyes. Next time you go to the beach, take a small bag and collect ten pieces of plastic. It takes five minutes.

The 20 words

Day 1 · Vocabulary table · Topic: The ocean, beaches and islands

What to do: Book: 4000 EEW 1, Unit 9, pages 56–59. Copy the words you do not know into the copybook.

Word	Meaning	По-русски	Example
against prep.	touching or fighting something; opposite to	против; о (обо что-то)	He leaned against the wall.
beach n.	sandy or stony land next to the sea	пляж	We played volleyball on the beach.
damage n./v.	harm to something so it does not work or look good	вред; повреждать	The storm damaged many houses.
discover v.	find or learn something for the first time	обнаруживать, открывать	She discovered a small cave.
emotion n.	a strong feeling, like joy or sadness	эмоция, чувство	Love and fear are strong emotions.
fix v.	repair; make something work again	чинить	Dad fixed my bike.
frank adj.	honest and direct	откровенный	To be frank, I don't like this song.
identify v.	say what or who something is	определять, узнавать	Can you identify this bird?
island n.	land with water all around	остров	They live on a small island.
ocean n.	the very big sea	океан	The Pacific is the biggest ocean.
perhaps adv.	maybe	возможно	Perhaps it will rain tomorrow.
pleasant adj.	nice, enjoyable	приятный	We had a pleasant evening.
prevent v.	stop something from happening	предотвращать	Washing your hands prevents illness.
rock n.	a big hard piece of stone	камень, скала	The boy sat on a big rock.
save v.	keep safe from danger; keep for later	спасать; копить	The firefighter saved the cat.
step n.	one move with your foot; one part of a plan	шаг	Take one step forward.
still adv.	until now, and not changed	всё ещё	It is still raining.
taste v./n.	the flavor of food; to try with the mouth	пробовать; вкус	This soup tastes great.
throw v.	send through the air with your hand	бросать	Throw the ball to me!
wave n.	a moving line of water	волна	The waves were very big today.

More on the topic

Day 1 · Topic: The ocean, beaches and islands · more words

What to do: Choose 5 collocations to learn. Use the reserve words when a student already knows the main ones.

Collocations: words that go together

discover a new island	открыть новый остров
identify a bird	определить птицу
cause damage	наносить ущерб
prevent an accident	предотвратить несчастный случай
throw a ball	бросить мяч
fix a problem	решить проблему; починить
save energy · save a life	экономить энергию · спасти жизнь
take the first step	сделать первый шаг
a pleasant surprise	приятный сюрприз
a sandy beach	песчаный пляж
to be frank	честно говоря
strong emotions	сильные эмоции

Phrasal verbs

clean up	убирать, очищать	We cleaned up the beach.
wash up	выбросить на берег	Plastic washed up on the beach.
pick up	поднять	Pick up the bottle, please.
throw away	выбросить	Do not throw away plastic in the sea.
set out	отправиться	They set out at dawn.
run out of	закончиться	We ran out of water on the island.

Reserve words: for students who know the 20 already, or if you prefer another word

sand	песок	**swim**	плавать
shell	ракушка	**fish**	рыба; ловить рыбу
coast	побережье	**plastic**	пластик
shore	берег	**pollution**	загрязнение
sail	плыть под парусом	**tide**	прилив и отлив

What to read next · 4000 Essential English Words

This week: **Book 1, Unit 9, “The Starfish”**, pages 56–61. Next: **Unit 10, “The First Peacock”**, pages 62–67. About nature: **Unit 5, “The Jackal and the Sun Child”**, pages 32–37.